CONFOEDERATIO,
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EMANCIPATION, THE PALE OF SETTLEMENT AND THE PEOPLING OF THE STEPPE AND SIBERIA

Population and Towns of Late Imperial Russia

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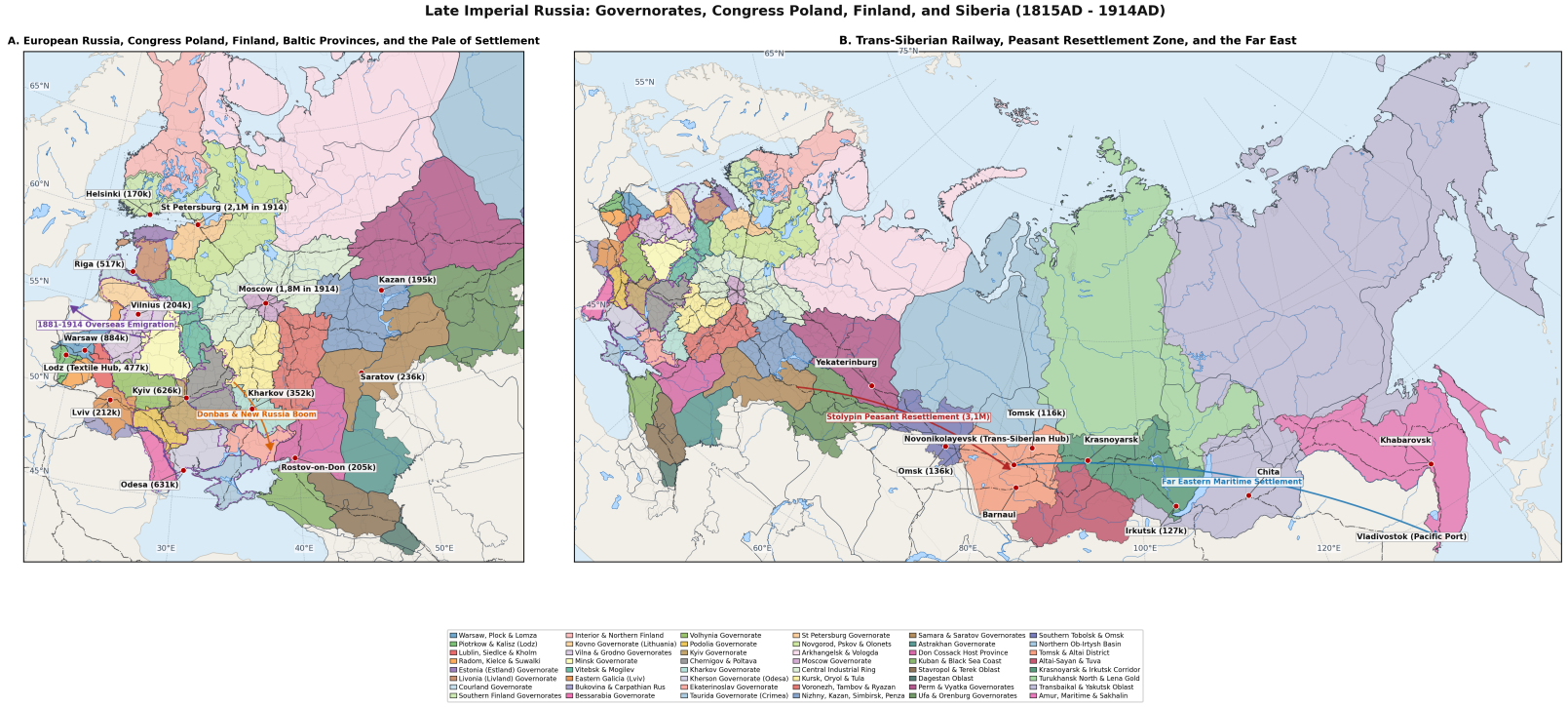


Figure 1. The 48 provinces and principal cities of Late Imperial Russia and Austro-Hungarian Ukraine from 1815AD to 1917AD, showing Congress Poland, the Baltic governorates, the Grand Duchy of Finland, the Pale of Settlement, New Russia, the North Caucasus and the Trans-Siberian railway belt.

Abstract

Between the Congress of Vienna in 1815AD and the fall of the Romanov monarchy in 1917AD, the population of the Russian Empire and the Ukrainian crownlands of Austria-Hungary (covering 18,61M km^2 across 48 provinces, excluding Central Asia and the Southern Caucasus) nearly tripled. Under the final decades of serfdom, total numbers rose from 57,87M in 1815AD to 83,92M at the Tenth Soul Revision in 1858AD. Following the peasant emancipations of the 1860s, the spread of railways and the industrial boom in Poland, the Donbas and the two capitals, the population climbed to 123,89M at the 1897AD Census and reached a pre-war peak of 167,94M on 1 January 1914AD. First World War mobilisation, frontline casualties and the flight of more than 6M refugees from the western borderlands reduced the total slightly to 165,38M in 1917AD [1][2][3][4][5][6].

Background

Between 1815AD and 1917AD, Eastern Europe and Northern Asia were divided into 48 provinces and regional groupings whose laws, land tenure and railways shaped where people lived and how fast their numbers grew (Figure 1 and Table 1).

In the west, three territories acquired between 1809AD and 1815AD kept their own legal codes, customs borders and statistical offices [7][8][9][10]. These were Congress Poland (Regions 1-4, covering the ten Vistula governorates of Warsaw, Plock, Lomza, Piotrkow, Kalisz, Lublin, Siedlce with the 1912AD Kholm split, Radom, Kielce and Suwalki), the three Baltic governorates ruled by German-speaking nobility (Regions 5-7, covering Estland, Livland and Courland, where the abolition of serfdom in 1816-1819AD triggered the Empire's earliest decline in birth rates) and the Grand Duchy of Finland (Regions 8-9, covering all eight Finnish provinces administered by the Senate in Helsingfors).

East of the Vistula and Baltic provinces, the Pale of Permanent Jewish Settlement, codified in 1835AD and tightened under the May Laws of 1882AD, confined Jewish residence to Lithuania and Belarus (Regions 10-13, covering Kovno, Vilna, Grodno, Minsk, Vitebsk and Mogilev), Bessarabia (Region 16), Right-Bank Ukraine (Regions 17-19, covering Volhynia, Podolia and Kyiv), Left-Bank Ukraine (Region 20, covering Chernigov and Poltava) and New Russia (Regions 22-24, covering Kherson, Ekaterinoslav and Taurida), alongside separate civil regulations in Congress Poland [11][12][13][14]. Across the southwestern border, Habsburg-ruled Ukrainian lands were split after the 1867AD Compromise between Austrian rule in Eastern Galicia (Region 14, with Lemberg/Lviv, Tarnopol, Stanislau and the Boryslav oil basin) and Bukovina (Czernowitz), and Hungarian rule in the Subcarpathian counties of Bereg, Ung, Ugocsa and Maramaros in Region 15 [15][16][17][18].

Within the Russian interior, acute peasant land shortage after the 1861AD emancipation and the 1891-1892AD Volga and Black-Earth famine in Regions 20 and 30-32 stood in sharp contrast to the booming capitals of Saint Petersburg (Region 25) and Moscow (Region 28) and the coal, iron and grain belt across Kherson, Ekaterinoslav, Taurida and the Don Cossack Host in Regions 22-24 and 35 [19][20][21][22]. Along the North Caucasian frontier, Regions 36-38 separate Kuban Oblast and the Black Sea Governorate - the main theatre of the 1860-1864AD Circassian expulsion and subsequent Cossack and Slavic settlement - from Stavropol Governorate and Terek Oblast (Vladikavkaz, the Grozny oilfields and the Vainakh and Ossetian highlands) and highland Dagestan Oblast [23][24][25][26]. In Asian Russia (Regions 41-48), the southern farm belt along the Trans-Siberian Railway, the Altai Cabinet lands and the Amur-Ussuri valleys (Regions 41, 43, 45 and 48, which took in over 3M peasant migrants under Stolypin between 1906AD and 1914AD) grew rapidly, while the northern Ob-Irtysh river trail (Region 42), the Altai-Sayan and Uriankhai highlands (Region 44), the Yenisei-Turukhansk north and Lena goldfields (Region 46) and Transbaikal and Yakutsk (Region 47) remained sparsely settled [27][28][29][30].

Region/ Governorate/ Oblast	Area (km²)	1815AD	1833AD	1858AD	1885AD	1897AD	1914AD	1917AD
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Gubs.	35,96k	1,02M	1,28M	1,62M	2,65M	3,54M	5,05M	4,42M
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Gubs.	20,16k	720k	940k	1,24M	1,98M	2,24M	3,32M	2,95M
3. Lublin & Siedlce Gubs.	27,34k	780k	960k	1,18M	1,74M	1,93M	2,68M	2,08M

4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Gubs.	33,39k	780k	950k	1,16M	1,68M	2,16M	2,6M	2,18M
5. Estland Gub.	22,64k	232k	275k	312k	382k	413k	505k	515k
6. Livland Gub.	54,24k	615k	735k	885k	1,19M	1,3M	1,56M	1,42M
7. Courland Gub.	27,59k	418k	495k	565k	655k	674k	800k	380k
8. Southern Finland Gubs.: Nyland	114,32k	590k	745k	945k	1,2M	1,43M	1,84M	1,89M
9. Interior & Northern Finland Gubs.: Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg	263,82k	520k	645k	815k	1,01M	1,13M	1,4M	1,43M
10. Kovno Gub.	43,91k	660k	785k	965k	1,38M	1,54M	1,84M	1,32M
11. Vilna & Grodno Gubs.	85,29k	1,15M	1,36M	1,65M	2,68M	3,19M	3,94M	2,88M
12. Minsk Gub. & Pripyat Polesia	91,93k	920k	1,04M	1,21M	1,82M	2,15M	3,04M	2,89M
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Gubs.	83,64k	1,25M	1,41M	1,64M	2,58M	3,18M	4,02M	3,86M
14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	46,07k	2,58M	2,88M	3,36M	4,12M	4,42M	5,02M	4,45M
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	24,49k	770k	870k	1,03M	1,29M	1,4M	1,63M	1,5M
16. Bessarabia Gub.	47,38k	385k	640k	950k	1,58M	1,94M	2,66M	2,62M
17. Volhynia Gub.	76,53k	1,52M	1,68M	2,01M	2,64M	2,99M	4,12M	3,68M
18. Podolia Gub.	41,43k	1,44M	1,62M	1,98M	2,65M	3,02M	3,98M	3,82M
19. Kyiv Gub.	54,18k	940k	1,22M	1,78M	2,92M	3,56M	4,78M	4,84M
20. Little Russian Gubs.: Chernigov & Poltava	106,76k	3,35M	3,68M	4,34M	4,88M	5,08M	6,65M	6,72M
21. Kharkov Gub.	57,38k	1,1M	1,26M	1,59M	2,18M	2,49M	3,44M	3,51M
22. Kherson Gub.	75,5k	620k	880k	1,38M	2,24M	2,73M	3,75M	3,78M
23. Ekaterinoslav Gub.	60,21k	820k	1,04M	1,46M	1,92M	2,11M	3,45M	3,58M
24. Taurida Gub.	69,87k	370k	520k	660k	1,08M	1,45M	2,06M	2,08M

25. Saint Petersburg Gub.	62,71k	760k	940k	1,22M	1,76M	2,11M	3,15M	3,38M
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Gubs.	306,05k	1,77M	1,96M	2,26M	2,68M	2,85M	3,58M	3,68M
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Gubs.	1,31M	920k	1,04M	1,24M	1,54M	1,69M	2,22M	2,28M
28. Moscow Gub.	28,08k	1,12M	1,32M	1,62M	2,14M	2,43M	3,56M	3,82M
29. Central Industrial Ring: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma, Tver, Smolensk & Kaluga Gubs.	320,6k	6,75M	7,25M	8,08M	8,82M	9,16M	11,52M	11,88M
30. Western Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Kursk, Oryol & Tula	116,2k	4,52M	5,02M	5,88M	6,42M	6,21M	7,98M	8,18M
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Voronezh, Tambov & Ryazan	163,11k	5,12M	5,72M	6,76M	7,28M	7,04M	9,22M	9,45M
32. Middle Volga Gubs.: Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	196,69k	4,28M	4,82M	5,72M	6,52M	6,76M	8,35M	8,55M
33. Samara & Saratov Gubs.	257,22k	1,58M	2,18M	3,38M	4,68M	5,16M	6,88M	7,12M
34. Astrakhan Gub.	157,99k	380k	480k	640k	880k	1M	1,38M	1,41M
35. Don Cossack Host	173,01k	680k	880k	1,42M	2,12M	2,56M	3,88M	3,94M
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Gub.	100,01k	420k	480k	640k	1,38M	1,98M	3,06M	3,12M
37. Stavropol Gub. & Terek Oblast	131,16k	545k	640k	860k	1,48M	1,81M	2,61M	2,65M
38. Dagestan Oblast	30,66k	450k	440k	410k	530k	571k	715k	725k

39. Perm & Vyatka Gubs.	491,79k	1,92M	2,38M	3,42M	5,18M	6,03M	7,88M	8,04M
40. Ufa & Orenburg Gubs.	339,13k	1,4M	1,78M	2,56M	3,42M	3,8M	5,35M	5,48M
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt: Southern Tobolsk	244,12k	545k	680k	990k	1,48M	1,74M	3,18M	3,32M
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra: Tobolsk, Surgut, Berezov & Narym	1,64M	160k	185k	240k	325k	375k	505k	520k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	499,97k	300k	410k	690k	1,34M	1,93M	3,98M	4,18M
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands: Gorny Altai, Minusinsk & Uriankhai Protectorate	418,84k	125k	150k	205k	285k	330k	565k	575k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Achinsk-Krasnoyarsk-Kansk & Irkutsk	521,6k	210k	260k	375k	610k	795k	1,54M	1,56M
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	2,48M	68k	80k	110k	165k	195k	270k	265k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	6,01M	278k	320k	415k	680k	942k	1,29M	1,3M
48. Priamurye Gov.-Gen.: Amur, Primorskaya	1,04M	30k	35k	55k	195k	372k	1,14M	1,15M
Total (All 48 Regions)	18,61M	57,87M	67,36M	83,92M	110,35M	123,89M	167,94M	165,38M

Table 1. Regional population estimates and land areas across all 48 provinces at seven benchmark dates from the Congress of Vienna in 1815AD to the 1917AD wartime censuses.

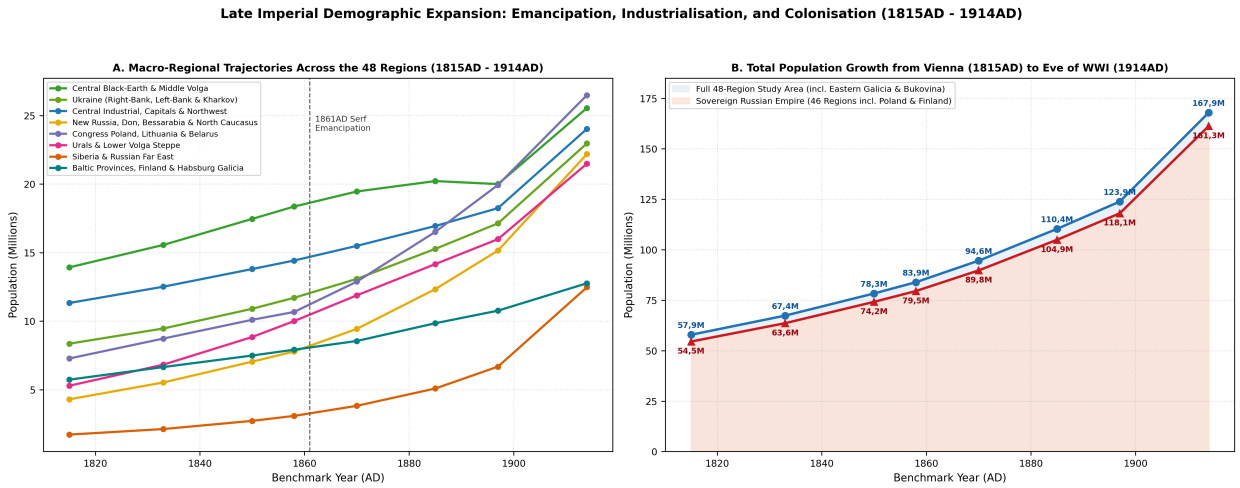


Figure 2. Population totals in millions across the seven main regional groupings from 1815AD to 1917AD (Panel A), and indexed growth relative to 1815AD = 100 showing the rapid expansion of Siberia, New Russia and Congress Poland after the 1860s (Panel B).

Methodology

Our provincial population figures across this 102-year period draw on seven main documentary and statistical series, summarised across all ten benchmark dates in Table 2.

For the decades before the 1861AD emancipation, the estimates rest on the last four Imperial Soul Revisions (*revizii*, VII-X, 1815-1858AD). Following the Seventh Revision (1815-1816AD), which recorded Napoleonic wartime losses across western and central provinces, fiscal commissions conducted the Eighth (1833-1835AD), Ninth (1850AD) and Tenth (1857-1858AD) Soul Revisions [1][31][32]. Unlike the male-only Sixth Revision of 1811AD, Revisions VII-X registered both sexes of the tax-paying estates. Following V. M. Kabuzan (1971AD, 1992AD) and A. G. Troinitsky (1861AD), the raw revision returns are combined with provincial statistical committee and police registers for tax-exempt nobles, clergy, civil servants, regular troops and Cossack hosts [2][22][33].

After emancipation, population tracking passed to the Central Statistical Committee (*Tsentralnyy Statisticheskiy Komitet*, TsSK MVD) for 1863-1914AD. Set up within the Ministry of Internal Affairs under P. P. Semenov, the committee published periodic volumes (*Statisticheskiy vremennik Rossiyskoy imperii*) and, from 1904AD to 1915AD, annual yearbooks (*Statisticheskiy ezhegodnik Rossii*), combining Orthodox, Lutheran, Catholic, Jewish and Muslim parish registers with *zemstvo* household surveys [3][5][34].

The late nineteenth-century figures are anchored by the First All-Russian General Census of 28 January 1897AD. Directed by Semenov-Tyan-Shansky and edited by N. A. Troinitsky across 89 provincial volumes (1899-1905AD), the 1897AD Census counted 125,64M residents present across the Empire excluding Finland [4][35]. Across our 46 Russian, Polish, Baltic, Siberian and Finnish regions, the 1897AD benchmark comes to 118,06M (115,51M across the 44 Imperial and Vistula regions - matching the 1897AD Census provincial totals minus the 10,13M inhabitants of Transcaucasia and Central Asia outside the study area - plus 2,56M in the Grand Duchy of Finland), which together with 5,82M in Austro-Hungarian Galicia, Bukovina and Subcarpathia gives the 48-region total of 123,89M [4][15][36].

In the western borderlands, separate statistical offices kept their own records. Because the Grand Duchy of Finland retained its Swedish-era Lutheran parish registers (*kirkonkirjat* and *vaestotaulut*, begun in

1749AD) and established its own Central Statistical Office (*Tilastollinen paatoimisto*) in 1865AD, Regions 8-9 have continuous five- and ten-year series from 1815AD to 1910AD (1,11M in 1815AD, 1,76M in 1858AD, 1,77M in 1870AD after the 1866-1868AD famine, 2,56M in 1897AD and 3,05M in 1910AD) [36][37]. For the ten Vistula Governorates (Regions 1-4), civil registers introduced under the Napoleonic Code in 1808AD and the 40 volumes published by the Warsaw Statistical Committee (1888-1914AD) reconcile permanent residents and temporary industrial migrants in Warsaw, Lodz and Sosnowiec alongside the 1897AD Census (9,87M in 1897AD and 13,65M on 1 January 1914AD) [7][38][39].

Across the Habsburg frontier, Regions 14-15 rely before 1857AD on Josephinian military conscription rolls and from 1869AD to 1910AD on the ten-year censuses of the Vienna Statistical Commission for Eastern Galicia and Bukovina and the Budapest Statistical Office for Subcarpathia [15][16]. Finally, after plans for a Second Imperial Census in 1915AD were shelved [40], the Ministry of Agriculture and the Provisional Government carried out the 1916AD and 1917AD All-Russian Agricultural, Land and Urban Censuses [41][42]. Combined with the refugee rolls of the Tatiana Committee and *Zemgor* studied by Peter Gatrell (1999AD), these counts track the displacement of over 6M wartime refugees (*bezhentsy*) by early 1917AD [6][43].

Benchmark & Source	Poland (1-4)	Balt.-Fin. (5-9)	Pale-Bess. (10-19*)	Habsb. (14-15)	Ukraine-Cauc. (20-24,36-38)	Heartland-Ural (25-35,39-40)	Siberia-FE (41-48)	Total (48 Regs)
1815AD (Revision VII/ Vienna Act)	3,3M	2,38M	8,26M	3,35M	7,68M	31,2M	1,72M	57,87M
1833AD (Revision VIII/Parish)	4,13M	2,9M	9,76M	3,75M	8,94M	35,77M	2,12M	67,36M
1850AD (Revision IX/ Conscript)	4,91M	3,34M	11,35M	4,15M	10,56M	41,32M	2,72M	78,34M
1858AD (Revision X/ 1857 Habsb.)	5,2M	3,52M	12,19M	4,39M	11,34M	44,2M	3,08M	83,92M
1870AD (TsSK/1869 A-H/Fin.)	6,34M	3,73M	14,34M	4,82M	13,03M	48,51M	3,82M	94,58M
1885AD (TsSK/ Zemstvo/VSK)	8,05M	4,43M	18,25M	5,41M	15,69M	53,44M	5,08M	110,35M
1897AD (1st Imperial Census)	9,87M	4,94M	21,57M	5,82M	18,22M	56,79M	6,68M	123,89M
1910AD (TsSK/1910 A-H & Fin.)	12,67M	5,77M	26,74M	6,45M	23,74M	70,03M	10,82M	156,22M
1914AD (TsSK/VSK Pre-WWI Peak)	13,65M	6,11M	28,38M	6,65M	25,74M	74,95M	12,47M	167,94M

1917AD (Ag.-Urban Census/WWI)	11,63M	5,64M	25,91M	5,95M	26,16M	77,21M	12,88M	165,38M

Table 2. Population totals across the seven main regional groupings at all ten revision, statistical committee and census benchmarks from 1815AD to 1917AD.

Results

Congress Poland, the Baltic Provinces and Finland

Congress Poland

Created at the Congress of Vienna in 1815AD out of the Napoleonic Duchy of Warsaw and reorganised into ten Vistula Governorates in 1867AD, Congress Poland (116,85k km^2 across Regions 1-4) grew faster than any other western territory in the Empire, more than quadrupling from 3,3M in 1815AD (28,2 per km^2) to 5,2M in 1858AD, 9,87M in 1897AD and 13,65M in 1914AD (116,8 per km^2) [7][38]. Although the November (1830-1831AD) and January (1863-1864AD) Uprisings brought wartime casualties, estate confiscations and deportations to Siberia, Tsar Alexander II's Polish Emancipation Ukase of 2 March 1864AD gave Polish, Ukrainian and Lithuanian peasants freehold title to their land without direct redemption payments to landlords, sustaining rural natural growth of 1,6-1,9% a year [2][44].

At the same time, the abolition of the Russo-Polish customs barrier in 1851AD, the opening of the Warsaw-Vienna (1848AD) and Warsaw-Saint Petersburg (1862AD) railways and the high Imperial gold tariff of 1877AD turned Congress Poland into the leading textile and coal-and-steel workshop for the Russian market [7][39][45].

In northern Mazovia, the Warsaw, Plock and Lomza governorates (Region 1) rose from 1,02M in 1815AD to 3,54M in 1897AD and 5,05M in 1914AD, led by Warsaw, the Empire's third largest city (growing from 81k in 1815AD to 162,8k in 1858AD, 683,7k in 1897AD and 884,5k in 1914AD, when 36,9% of its people were Jewish), alongside the linen-mill town of Zyrardow (38,6k) and the Vistula river ports of Wloclawek (37,4k) and Plock (35,2k) [7][38]. To the southwest, the Piotrkow and Kalisz governorates (Region 2) grew nearly fivefold from 720k in 1815AD to 2,25M in 1897AD and 3,32M in 1914AD. Chosen as a factory settlement in 1820AD when it had fewer than 800 inhabitants, Lodz grew to 29,5k in 1858AD, 314k in 1897AD and 477,9k in 1914AD (or over 550k with its mill suburbs of Pabianice and Zgierz), while coal mining and ironworks in the Dabrowa Basin along the Silesian border turned small villages into the industrial towns of Sosnowiec (118,5k in 1914AD, chartered only in 1902AD), Czestochowa (92,9k) and Bendzin (54,8k) [39][45].

East of the Vistula and across the southern uplands, the Lublin and Siedlce governorates (Region 3) and the Radom, Kielce and Suwalki governorates (Region 4) grew from 780k each in 1815AD to 2,68M and 2,6M in 1914AD, despite heavy overseas emigration from Suwalki and Kalisz to Brazil and North America between 1890AD and 1913AD [46]. In June 1912AD, Saint Petersburg detached the eastern districts of Lublin and Siedlce to form Kholm Governorate (Chelm, 24,6k) under Kiev [43]. During the German and Austro-Hungarian offensive of summer 1915AD, Russian military evacuation orders drove over 2M residents eastward, cutting Regions 1-4 from 13,65M in 1914AD to 11,63M in 1917AD; Region 3 fell by 22,4% (from 2,68M to 2,08M), while Kalisz was shelled to ruins in August 1914AD and shrank from 65,4k to 29k [6][43].

The Baltic Governorates

In Estland (Region 5), Livland (Region 6) and Courland (Region 7), Alexander I's emancipation acts of 1816AD (Estland), 1817AD (Courland) and 1819AD (Livland) ended serfdom forty years before inner Russia while leaving farmland in the hands of Baltic German nobles until tenant-purchase reforms in the 1850s and 1860s [9][47]. Combined with near-universal Lutheran literacy (92-96% adult literacy in 1897AD compared with 21% across the Empire) and late marriage, the three Baltic provinces were the first in the Russian Empire to see a lasting fall in marital birth rates between the 1860s and 1880s, forty to fifty years ahead of Central Russia [8][9][48].

As a result, rural population growth across Regions 5-7 was modest (rising from 1,26M in 1815AD to 1,76M in 1858AD, 2,39M in 1897AD and 2,87M in 1914AD), whereas port and factory towns grew rapidly. Riga (Region 6) expanded from 36k in 1815AD to 282,2k in 1897AD and 517,5k in 1914AD as the Empire's leading timber-export port and a major producer of rubber goods, chemicals, electrical equipment and railway carriages. In Estland (Region 5), Reval/Tallinn grew to 137,6k in 1914AD and 159k in 1917AD around its naval shipyards, while Dorpat/Tartu (48,6k) remained the university town of the Baltic provinces. In Courland (Region 7), the ice-free port of Libau/Liepaja (90,7k in 1914AD) served as the home port of the Russian American Line, carrying 40k-70k Jewish and Baltic emigrants each year to New York [13][47]. In spring and summer 1915AD, the German army occupied Courland (Region 7), driving half its people into interior Russia (800k in 1914AD to 380k in 1917AD, -52,5%), while the evacuation of Riga's factory machinery and over 300k workers and family members halved Riga's population to 210k and lowered Livland (Region 6) from 1,56M to 1,42M [6].

The Grand Duchy of Finland

Self-governing since the Diet of Porvoo in 1809AD and enlarged by the return of Old Finland (Viipuri/Vyborg province) in 1812AD, the Grand Duchy of Finland (378,13k km^2 across Regions 8-9) grew steadily from 1,11M in 1815AD (590k in southern and coastal Region 8; 520k in interior and northern Region 9) to 1,76M in 1858AD [36][49]. This steady rise was interrupted by Europe's last great peacetime famine in 1866-1868AD. After wet summers and a hard frost in early September 1867AD destroyed the rye and barley crops across Ostrobothnia, Savo and Kainuu, winter hunger and typhus, dysentery and relapsing fever in crowded relief shelters killed around 150k people, or roughly 8% of Finland's population, pushing the national death rate to 77,6 per 1k in 1868AD [10][37][50][51]. In our figures, Region 9 (Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel and Uleaborg) drops from 815k in 1858AD to 805k in 1870AD, while Region 8 (Nyland, Abo-Bjorneborg, Tavastehus and Vyborg) barely edges up from 945k to 965k.

After 1870AD, the opening of the Riihimaki-Saint Petersburg railway (1870AD), dairy farming and the growth of steam sawmills, pulp mills and paper works carried Finland's population from 1,77M in 1870AD to 2,56M in 1897AD, 3,24M in 1914AD and 3,32M in 1917AD (spared fighting before 1918AD), led by Helsingfors/Helsinki (4,8k in 1815AD to 84,5k in 1897AD and 187,5k in 1917AD), Abo/Turku (54,6k), Tammerfors/Tampere (45,2k) and Viipuri/Vyborg (29,3k), even as some 300k rural Finns (mainly from Vasa province in Region 9) emigrated to North America between 1880AD and 1914AD [36][49].

Region (1-9)	1815AD	1850AD	1858AD	1870AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
1. Warsaw, Plock & Lomza Gubs.	1,02M	1,52M	1,62M	1,98M	3,54M	4,68M	5,05M	4,42M
2. Piotrkow & Kalisz Gubs.	720k	1,16M	1,24M	1,56M	2,24M	3,05M	3,32M	2,95M
3. Lublin & Siedlce Gubs.	780k	1,12M	1,18M	1,42M	1,93M	2,48M	2,68M	2,08M

4. Radom, Kielce & Suwalki Gubs.	780k	1,11M	1,16M	1,38M	2,16M	2,46M	2,6M	2,18M
5. Estland Gub.	232k	302k	312k	338k	413k	475k	505k	515k
6. Livland Gub.	615k	835k	885k	1M	1,3M	1,48M	1,56M	1,42M
7. Courland Gub.	418k	545k	565k	615k	674k	765k	800k	380k
8. Southern Finland Gubs.: Nyland	590k	890k	945k	965k	1,43M	1,72M	1,84M	1,89M
9. Interior & Northern Finland Gubs.: Vasa, Kuopio, Sankt-Michel & Uleaborg	520k	765k	815k	805k	1,13M	1,33M	1,4M	1,43M

Table 3. Population estimates across Congress Poland, the Baltic governorates and the Grand Duchy of Finland from 1815AD to 1917AD, showing the 1866-1868AD Finnish famine and the 1915AD wartime evacuation of Poland and Courland.

The Pale of Settlement, Bessarabia and Austro-Hungarian Ukraine

Lithuania and Belarus

Across the Lithuanian and Belarusian governorates of the Northwestern Krai (304,76k km^2, Regions 10-13), total population grew from 3,97M in 1815AD to 5,46M in 1858AD, 10,06M in 1897AD and 12,84M in 1914AD [2][4][52][53].

In Lithuania, Kovno Governorate (Region 10, formed in 1843AD) rose from 660k in 1815AD to 1,54M in 1897AD and 1,84M in 1914AD. Heavy Russification after the 1863AD uprising, few factories outside Kovno/Kaunas (growing from 5,2k to 91,4k) and Shavli/Siauliai (23,5k) and the subdivision of peasant holdings prompted 250k-300k Lithuanians and Litvak Jews to emigrate to Pennsylvania, Chicago, Scotland and South America between 1880AD and 1914AD, before the 1915AD German occupation cut Kovno's population by 28,3% to 1,32M in 1917AD [6][13][54].

Farther south and east, the Vilna and Grodno governorates (Region 11, rising from 1,15M to 3,19M in 1897AD and 3,94M in 1914AD), Minsk Governorate and Pripyat Polesia (Region 12, 920k to 2,15M and 3,04M) and the Vitebsk and Mogilev governorates including the Catholic Latgalian districts of Dvinsk, Rezhitsa and Lyutsin (Region 13, 1,25M to 3,18M and 4,02M) formed the small-town (*shtetl*) heartland of the Pale [11][14][55]. After Alexander III's May Laws of 3 May 1882AD barred Jews from settling anew in villages, Jewish communities (8-17,5% of the provincial totals) made up 50-65% of the towns, including Vilna (32k to 204,3k), the Bialystok woollen-mill boomtown (6,2k to 91,5k, site of the June 1906AD pogrom), Dvinsk/Daugavpils (4,2k to 112,8k), Minsk (13,2k to 117,6k), Vitebsk (14,5k to 108,9k), Gomel (5,8k to 104,5k), Grodno (7,2k to 61,6k) and Brest-Litovsk (6,4k to 57,4k, burned and evacuated to 16,5k in August 1915AD) [13][56]. Between 1906AD and 1914AD, crowded Belarusian villages in Mogilev, Vitebsk and Minsk also sent over 340k peasant settlers to Siberia [57], while the 1915AD front line split Region 11 (falling from 3,94M to 2,88M, -26,9%) from Russian army headquarters at Mogilev [6].

Bessarabia and Right-Bank Ukraine

Taken from the Ottoman Principality of Moldavia at the Treaty of Bucharest in 1812AD, Bessarabia Governorate (Region 16, 47,38k km^2) grew nearly sevenfold from 385k in 1815AD to 950k in 1858AD, 1,94M in 1897AD and 2,66M in 1914AD (2,62M in 1917AD), driven by state-backed Bulgarian, Gagauz, German, Ukrainian and Russian settlement across the southern Budjak steppe alongside a Moldovan rural majority and fast-growing Kishinev/Chisinau (14,5k to 108,5k in 1897AD and 128,7k in 1914AD), Bender (31,8k), Akkerman (28,3k) and Ismail (22,3k) [4][58][59]. Southern Bessarabia (Cahul, Bolgrad and Ismail districts) was ceded to Moldavia under the 1856AD Treaty of Paris and taken back by Russia at the 1878AD Congress of Berlin. In April 1903AD, the Kishinev Pogrom (49 killed), followed by the October 1905AD pogroms in Odessa, Kyiv and Bialystok, set off the largest wave of Jewish emigration from the Empire, sending roughly 1,25M people to the United States between 1903AD and 1914AD out of some 2M total emigrants from the Pale between 1881AD and 1914AD [12][13][60].

In Right-Bank Ukraine (Regions 17-19, covering Volhynia, Podolia and Kyiv Governorates), the curbing of Polish noble autonomy after 1831AD and 1863AD and the rise of large sugar-beet estates and refineries (producing over 80% of the Empire's refined sugar under the Brodsky, Tereshchenko and Bobrinsky families) supported some of Europe's densest black-earth farming populations [61][62]. Volhynia (Region 17) grew from 1,52M in 1815AD to 2,99M in 1897AD and 4,12M in 1914AD before fighting on the Southwestern Front in 1915-1916AD and the Russian Army's deportation of some 150k Volhynian Germans and border Jews reduced it to 3,68M in 1917AD. Podolia (Region 18) rose from 1,44M to 3,02M in 1897AD (72,8 per km^2) and 3,98M in 1914AD, while Kyiv Governorate (Region 19) quintupled from 940k in 1815AD to 3,56M in 1897AD and 4,78M in 1914AD (rising to 4,84M in 1917AD with wartime army and refugee inflows), led by Kyiv (23,5k in 1815AD to 247,7k in 1897AD and 626,3k in 1914AD) [4][6].

Galicia, Bukovina and Subcarpathian Rus

Across the Habsburg border, the abolition of compulsory peasant labour (*Robota*) during the Revolutions of 1848AD freed Ukrainian (*Ruthenian*) smallholders in Eastern Galicia (Region 14, growing from 2,58M in 1815AD to 3,36M in 1858AD, 4,42M in 1897AD and 5,02M in 1914AD) and in Bukovina and Hungarian Subcarpathian Rus (Region 15, rising from 770k to 1,03M, 1,4M and 1,63M) [15][16][17]. Despite the turn-of-the-century oil boom around Boryslav and Drohobych (Drohobych 36,5k and Boryslav 16,8k, making Galicia the world's third-largest oil producer in 1909AD) and the growth of Lemberg/Lviv (44,5k to 212k) and Czernowitz/Chernivtsi (7,2k to 94k) [18][63], extreme subdivision of peasant farms (over 80% of holdings were under 5 ha) drove more than 400k Galician, Bukovinian and Transcarpathian Ukrainians and Jews to settle on the Canadian prairies or take factory jobs in the United States between 1885AD and 1914AD. Between August 1914AD and 1917AD, four major Russo-Austrian offensives across Galicia and the Carpathian passes, Austro-Hungarian military executions and internments at Thalerhof and Russian wartime deportations reduced Region 14 from 5,02M to 4,45M (-11,4%) and Region 15 from 1,63M to 1,5M (-8%) [6].

Region (10-19)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
10. Kovno Gub.	660k	915k	1,12M	1,38M	1,54M	1,76M	1,84M	1,32M
11. Vilna & Grodno Gubs.	1,15M	1,56M	2,02M	2,68M	3,19M	3,78M	3,94M	2,88M
12. Minsk Gub. & Pripyat Polesia	920k	1,15M	1,42M	1,82M	2,15M	2,82M	3,04M	2,89M
13. Vitebsk & Mogilev Gubs.	1,25M	1,56M	1,98M	2,58M	3,18M	3,82M	4,02M	3,86M

14. Austro-Hungarian Eastern Galicia	2,58M	3,18M	3,68M	4,12M	4,42M	4,88M	5,02M	4,45M
15. Austro-Hungarian Bukovina	770k	970k	1,14M	1,29M	1,4M	1,57M	1,63M	1,5M
16. Bessarabia Gub.	385k	860k	1,16M	1,58M	1,94M	2,48M	2,66M	2,62M
17. Volhynia Gub.	1,52M	1,88M	2,24M	2,64M	2,99M	3,82M	4,12M	3,68M
18. Podolia Gub.	1,44M	1,84M	2,22M	2,65M	3,02M	3,74M	3,98M	3,82M
19. Kyiv Gub.	940k	1,58M	2,18M	2,92M	3,56M	4,52M	4,78M	4,84M

Table 4. Population estimates across Lithuania, Belarus, Austro-Hungarian Galicia and Bukovina, Bessarabia and Right-Bank Ukraine from 1815AD to 1917AD.

Novorossiya, the Russian Heartland and the North Caucasus

Left-Bank Ukraine, New Russia and the Russian Heartland

Across the southern Ukrainian and Black Sea steppes, peasant ploughs and late-Imperial coal and steel works transformed a sparsely settled frontier into the industrial powerhouse of the southern Empire.

In Left-Bank and Sloboda Ukraine (Regions 20-21), Chernigov and Poltava (Region 20, rising from 3,35M to 5,08M in 1897AD and 6,65M in 1914AD) suffered severe land hunger after 1861AD and sent more peasant migrants to Siberia and the Far East than any other province [27], whereas Kharkov Governorate (Region 21, 1,1M to 2,49M and 3,44M) boomed around Kharkov (growing from 14,8k in 1815AD to 174k in 1897AD and 258k in 1914AD), its locomotive works and southern railway headquarters [62][64]. Farther south across New Russia and the Don Cossack Host (Regions 22-24 and 35), the Crimean War (1853-1856AD) in Taurida Governorate (Region 24) battered Sevastopol (which fell from 34k in 1833AD to 11,2k in 1858AD) and prompted the 1860-1862AD exodus of 180k-200k Crimean Tatars and Nogais to the Ottoman Empire, holding Region 24 nearly flat between 1850AD (640k) and 1858AD (660k), before mainland wheat farming and naval rebuilding lifted Taurida to 1,45M in 1897AD and 2,06M in 1914AD [40][65][66]. To the north and west, Kherson Governorate (Region 22, rising from 620k to 2,73M and 3,75M, led by the grain port of Odessa at 35k to 403,8k and 630k and the shipyards of Nikolaev at 108,8k) [21][67], Ekaterinoslav Governorate (Region 23, 820k to 2,11M and 3,45M) and the Don Cossack Host (Region 35, 680k to 2,56M and 3,88M, led by Rostov-on-Don at 204,8k and Taganrog at 78,6k) saw Europe's fastest heavy-industrial boom after the Catherine Railway (1884AD) linked Krivoy Rog iron ore with Donbas coking coal around John Hughes's ironworks at Yuzovka/Donetsk (growing from 0,9k in 1870AD to 28,1k in 1897AD and 54k in 1914AD), Ekaterinoslav (220,4k in 1914AD), Lugansk (68k) and Mariupol (58k) [20][68][69][70][71][72].

In the northern and central Russian heartland (Regions 25-34 and 39-40), Saint Petersburg Governorate (Region 25, rising from 760k to 2,11M in 1897AD, 3,15M in 1914AD and 3,38M in 1917AD, with the capital itself growing from 2,12M in 1914AD to 2,3M in 1917AD as the Putilov munitions works expanded) and Moscow Governorate (Region 28, rising from 1,12M to 2,43M, 3,56M and 3,82M, with the city reaching 1,76M in 1914AD and 1,85M in 1917AD) drew in millions of peasant migrant workers (*otkhodniki*) from Novgorod, Pskov and Olonets (Region 26), Arkhangelsk and Vologda (Region 27, where

Romanov-on-Murman/Murmansk was founded at the end of the Murman Railway in 1916AD) and the Central Industrial Ring (Region 29, rising from 6,75M to 11,52M, including the cotton-mill town of Ivanovo-Voznesensk at 146k) [3][73][74]. By contrast, the Central Black-Earth provinces (Regions 30-31) and the Middle and Lower Volga (Regions 32-34) suffered repeated crop failures and epidemics. After severe autumn and spring drought across seventeen black-earth and Volga provinces, the 1891-1892AD famine and cholera epidemic caused 400k-500k excess deaths, hitting Astrakhan, Saratov, Samara, Simbirsk, Kazan, Voronezh and Tambov hardest [19][75][76][77]. Combined with heavy peasant migration to the southern steppes and Siberia, total population in the Western Black-Earth provinces (Region 30, covering Kursk, Oryol and Tula) and the Eastern Black-Earth provinces (Region 31, covering Voronezh, Tambov and Ryazan) dipped between 1885AD and the 1897AD Census (from 6,42M to 6,21M and from 7,28M to 7,04M) before recovering to 7,98M and 9,22M by 1914AD [78][79][80]. Farther east, Samara and Saratov (Region 33, rising from 1,58M to 5,16M and 6,88M, home to over 400k Volga Germans and the river ports of Saratov at 235,9k, Samara at 143,8k and Tsaritsyn at 101k), Perm and Vyatka (Region 39, 1,92M to 6,03M and 7,88M, with Ekaterinburg at 70k and the Izhevsk gun works) and Ufa and Orenburg (Region 40, 1,4M to 3,8M and 5,35M, including the Trans-Siberian gateway of Chelyabinsk at 70,5k) grew steadily through peasant settlement and mining [81][82][83][84].

The North Caucasus

Across the North Caucasus (261,84k km^2, Regions 36-38), nineteenth-century population history was shaped by the Caucasian War (1817-1864AD). In the east, three decades of mountain fighting against Imam Shamil's Caucasian Imamate (1829-1859AD, ending at Gunib) reduced Dagestan Oblast (Region 38) from 450k in 1815AD to 410k in 1858AD before railway and port links through Petrovsk-Port/Makhachkala (24,8k) and Derbent (32,7k) lifted the population to 571k in 1897AD and 715k in 1914AD [24][26][85]. In the northwest, the final conquest of Circassia (1860-1864AD, ending at Kbaada in May 1864AD) was followed by the expulsion and Black Sea crossing of 500k-650k Circassians (Adyghe), Ubykhs and Abazas to the Ottoman Empire [23][25]. Immediately afterwards, land grants to Kuban Cossacks and incoming Ukrainian and Russian peasants pushed Kuban Oblast and the Black Sea Governorate (Region 36) nearly fivefold from 640k in 1858AD to 1,98M in 1897AD and 3,06M in 1914AD (led by Ekaterinodar at 107,1k and the cement and grain port of Novorossiysk at 66,7k), while Stavropol and Terek (Region 37) grew from 860k in 1858AD to 1,81M in 1897AD and 2,61M in 1914AD around Vladikavkaz (79,3k) and the Grozny oilfields (growing from 15,6k in 1897AD to 38,2k in 1914AD and 45k in 1917AD) [86][87][88].

Region (20-40)	1815AD	1850AD	1870AD	1885AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
20. Little Russian Gubs.: Chernigov & Poltava	3,35M	4,12M	4,62M	4,88M	5,08M	6,28M	6,65M	6,72M
21. Kharkov Gub.	1,1M	1,48M	1,82M	2,18M	2,49M	3,22M	3,44M	3,51M
22. Kherson Gub.	620k	1,22M	1,68M	2,24M	2,73M	3,48M	3,75M	3,78M
23. Ekaterinoslav Gub.	820k	1,32M	1,68M	1,92M	2,11M	3,06M	3,45M	3,58M
24. Taurida Gub.	370k	640k	780k	1,08M	1,45M	1,88M	2,06M	2,08M
25. Saint Petersburg Gub.	760k	1,12M	1,42M	1,76M	2,11M	2,86M	3,15M	3,38M
26. Novgorod, Pskov & Olonets Gubs.	1,77M	2,16M	2,44M	2,68M	2,85M	3,38M	3,58M	3,68M
27. Arkhangelsk & Vologda Gubs.	920k	1,18M	1,36M	1,54M	1,69M	2,08M	2,22M	2,28M
28. Moscow Gub.	1,12M	1,52M	1,82M	2,14M	2,43M	3,22M	3,56M	3,82M

29. Central Industrial Ring: Vladimir, Yaroslavl, Kostroma, Tver, Smolensk & Kaluga Gubs.	6,75M	7,82M	8,45M	8,82M	9,16M	10,85M	11,52M	11,88M
30. Western Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Kursk, Oryol & Tula	4,52M	5,62M	6,22M	6,42M	6,21M	7,52M	7,98M	8,18M
31. Eastern Central Black-Earth Gubs.: Voronezh, Tambov & Ryazan	5,12M	6,42M	7,12M	7,28M	7,04M	8,68M	9,22M	9,45M
32. Middle Volga Gubs.: Nizhny Novgorod, Kazan, Simbirsk & Penza	4,28M	5,42M	6,12M	6,52M	6,76M	7,92M	8,35M	8,55M
33. Samara & Saratov Gubs.	1,58M	2,96M	3,98M	4,68M	5,16M	6,42M	6,88M	7,12M
34. Astrakhan Gub.	380k	580k	740k	880k	1M	1,28M	1,38M	1,41M
35. Don Cossack Host	680k	1,22M	1,68M	2,12M	2,56M	3,52M	3,88M	3,94M
36. Kuban Oblast & Black Sea Gub.	420k	580k	860k	1,38M	1,98M	2,76M	3,06M	3,12M
37. Stavropol Gub. & Terek Oblast	545k	780k	1,12M	1,48M	1,81M	2,38M	2,61M	2,65M
38. Dagestan Oblast	450k	420k	470k	530k	571k	680k	715k	725k
39. Perm & Vyatka Gubs.	1,92M	3,02M	4,18M	5,18M	6,03M	7,38M	7,88M	8,04M
40. Ufa & Orenburg Gubs.	1,4M	2,28M	2,98M	3,42M	3,8M	4,92M	5,35M	5,48M

Table 5. Population estimates across Left-Bank Ukraine, New Russia, the Great Russian interior, the Volga, the North Caucasus and the Urals from 1815AD to 1917AD.

Siberia and the Far East

Across the 13,35M km^2 of Siberia and the Russian Far East (Regions 41-48), total population grew more than sevenfold from 1,72M in 1815AD to 3,08M in 1858AD, 6,68M in 1897AD, 12,47M in 1914AD and 12,88M

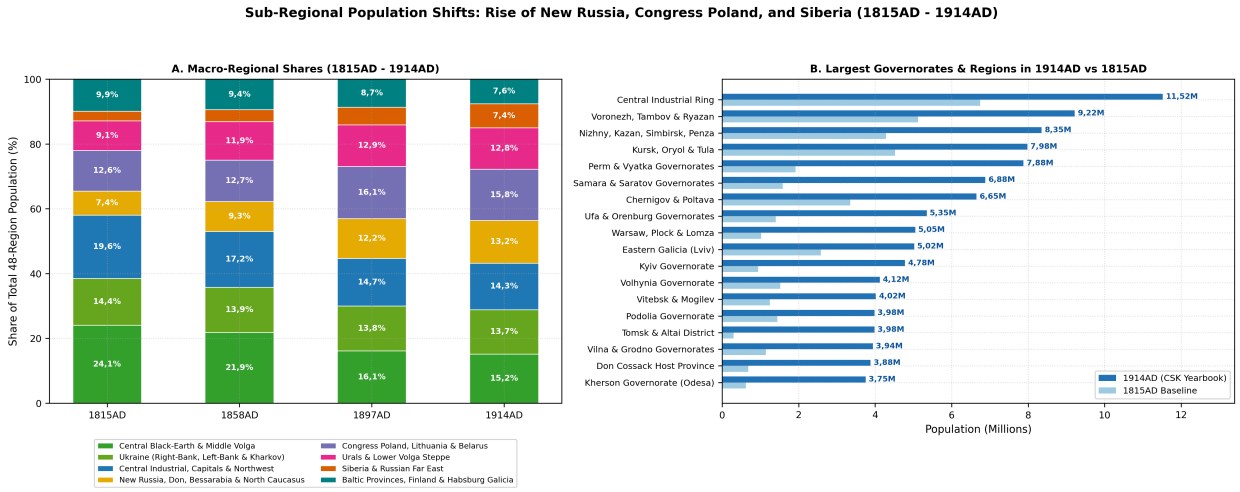


Figure 3. Population growth along the Trans-Siberian Railway and Amur-Ussuri valleys compared with the northern river basins from 1815AD to 1917AD (Panel A), and net wartime population losses in the western frontline provinces versus refugee gains in the interior between 1914AD and 1917AD (Panel B).

in 1917AD [27][28][29][89]. As shown in Figure 3A and Table 6, this growth was heavily concentrated along the Trans-Siberian Railway and the Amur-Ussuri river valleys (Regions 41, 43, 45 and 48), while the northern river basins, goldfields and native hunting lands (Regions 42, 44, 46 and 47) grew much more slowly.

The building of the Trans-Siberian Railway (1891-1916AD), begun at both Vladivostok and Chelyabinsk in 1891AD, transformed peasant settlement across the southern steppes and forest-steppe belt (Regions 41, 43 and 45). Backed after 1906AD by Prime Minister P. A. Stolypin's Resettlement Administration, which offered cheap farm loans, tool depots and subsidised fourth-class rail fares, peasant migration across the Urals topped 5M gross (and over 3,5M net) settlers between 1896AD and 1914AD, peaking in 1907-1909AD at 665k-759k migrants a year [27][28][90][91]. The Tomsk railway belt and Altai Cabinet lands (Region 43) took in more Stolypin settlers than any other part of the Empire, growing nearly fourteenfold from 300k in 1815AD to 1,93M in 1897AD, 3,98M in 1914AD and 4,18M in 1917AD as newcomers ploughed fertile black earth leased from the Tsar's Cabinet around Barnaul (growing from 7,4k in 1815AD to 61k in 1914AD), Biysk (33,5k) and the Ob bridge rail boomtown of Novonikolaevsk/Novosibirsk (founded in 1893AD; rising from 7,8k in 1897AD to 85k in 1914AD and 107k in 1917AD), which soon overtook the older university and provincial seat of Tomsk (116,7k in 1914AD) [90][92]. Similarly, the Southern Tobolsk and Omsk railway belt (Region 41) grew from 545k in 1815AD to 1,74M in 1897AD and 3,18M in 1914AD, led by Omsk (37,4k in 1897AD to 135,8k in 1914AD) and the butter-exporting town of Kurgan (38,5k) [93][94][95], while the Central Siberian rail belt (Region 45) rose from 210k to 1,54M around Krasnoyarsk (87,5k) and Irkutsk (129,7k) [96].

By contrast, the northern river basins and southern mountain borderlands bypassed by the main rail line grew far more slowly (Regions 42, 44, 46 and 47). Along the northern Ob and Irtysh rivers (Region 42, covering Tobolsk, Berezov, Surgut, Obdorsk and Narym), population rose modestly from 160k to 375k and 505k, with the old provincial capital of Tobolsk stalling at 20,4k to 24,5k once the railway passed 250 km to the south. The Altai-Sayan highlands and Uriankhai (Region 44) grew from 125k to 565k in 1914AD, taking in Minusinsk farmers, Altai herders [97] and Tuva (Uriankhai), which was placed under a Russian protectorate in April 1914AD with its administrative post at Belotsarsk (Kyzyl). In the Yenisei-Turukhansk

north and Lena goldfields (Region 46, rising from 68k to 195k and 270k), the old river town of Yeniseysk (5,8k to 11,9k) stood alongside the remote placer camps around Bodaibo (11,8k in 1914AD), where troops shot over 200 striking Lena Goldfields miners on 4 April 1912AD. Farther east, Transbaikal and Yakutsk Oblasts (Region 47, growing from 278k to 942k and 1,29M) combined Sakha and Buryat herders (roughly 225k Yakuts and 180k Transbaikal Buryats in 1897AD), the Nerchinsk convict mines, Yakutsk (10,8k in 1914AD) and the railway junction of Chita (growing from 0,7k in 1815AD to 79,2k in 1914AD) [89][98].

In the Russian Far East, the Priamurye region (Region 48, covering Amur, Primorskaya and Sakhalin across 1,04M km^2) was annexed from Qing China under the Treaty of Aigun (1858AD) and the Convention of Peking (1860AD), and its population grew nearly fortyfold from 30k native Tungusic and Nivkh inhabitants in 1815AD and 55k in 1858AD to 372k in 1897AD, 1,14M in 1914AD and 1,15M in 1917AD [30][99]. Growth was driven by Amur and Ussuri Cossacks and more than 250k Ukrainian peasants from Poltava, Chernigov and Kyiv who arrived by sea from Odessa or along the Chinese Eastern (1903AD) and Amur (1916AD) railways to farm the Ussuri valley around Nikolsk-Ussuriysky (47,4k) and build the towns of Vladivostok (rising from 3,2k in 1870AD to 108k in 1917AD as an Allied supply port), Blagoveshchensk (62,5k) and Khabarovsk (51,3k). On Sakhalin, acquired in full in exchange for the Kuril Islands under the 1875AD Treaty of Saint Petersburg (with 3,9k penal exiles and guards at Aleksandrovsky Post in 1897AD), defeat in the Russo-Japanese War (1904-1905AD) forced Russia to cede the southern half of the island (Karafuto, south of 50°N) to Japan under the September 1905AD Treaty of Portsmouth [30].

Region (41-48)	1815AD	1850AD	1858AD	1870AD	1897AD	1910AD	1914AD	1917AD
41. West Siberian Trans-Siberian Belt: Southern Tobolsk	545k	880k	990k	1,18M	1,74M	2,78M	3,18M	3,32M
42. Ob-Irtysh River Trail & Polar Tundra: Tobolsk, Surgut, Berezov & Narym	160k	220k	240k	275k	375k	465k	505k	520k
43. Tomsk Railway Trunk	300k	580k	690k	920k	1,93M	3,42M	3,98M	4,18M
44. Altai-Sayan Highlands: Gorny Altai, Minusinsk & Uriankhai Protectorate	125k	185k	205k	240k	330k	495k	565k	575k
45. Central Siberian Trans-Siberian Corridor: Achinsk-Krasnoyarsk-Kansk & Irkutsk	210k	330k	375k	460k	795k	1,32M	1,54M	1,56M
46. Yenisei-Turukhansk Polar North & Bodaibo Lena Goldfields	68k	98k	110k	135k	195k	245k	270k	265k
47. Transbaikal Oblast	278k	380k	415k	510k	942k	1,18M	1,29M	1,3M

48. Priamurye Gov.-Gen.: Amur, Primorskaya	30k	45k	55k	95k	372k	920k	1,14M	1,15M

Table 6. Population estimates across the eight Siberian and Far Eastern regions from 1815AD to 1917AD, contrasting the Stolypin railway settlement belt with the northern taiga and tundra.

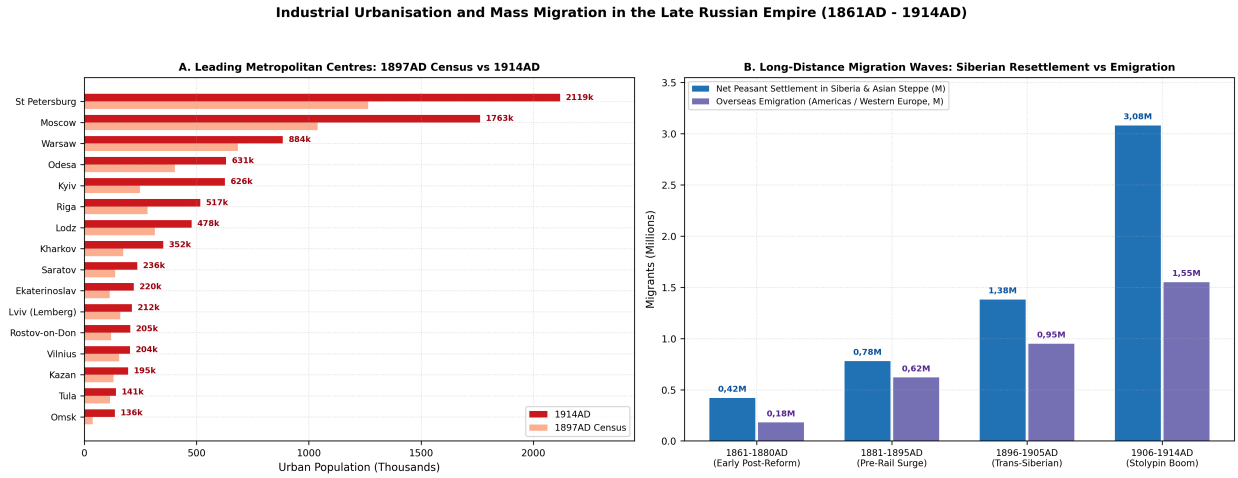


Figure 4. Population of the largest cities at the 1897AD Census and on the eve of the First World War in 1914AD (Panel A), and the growth of leading industrial, port and railway towns from 1815AD to 1917AD (Panel B).

Conclusion

Between 1815AD and 1914AD, the population across these 48 provinces nearly tripled from 57,87M to 167,94M, shifting the demographic weight of the Empire outward from the old forest and black-earth interior toward the industrial cities of Congress Poland and the Baltic coast, the coal and wheat belt of New Russia and the Donbas, the North Caucasian steppes and the Trans-Siberian railway corridor. While rural overcrowding in the Central Black-Earth provinces, Left-Bank Ukraine, the Pale of Settlement and Galicia sent millions of migrants eastward across the Urals and westward across the Atlantic, the First World War abruptly halted growth along the western frontier, uprooting more than 6M refugees between 1914AD and 1917AD on the eve of the Russian Revolution.

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